// Portfolio

Mark Herdt

Game Designer & Unity Developer

I've been making games for 7 years. I like building mechanics and systems that feed into each other, then playtesting them until they feel right. My game Watermelon Game is on Steam with over 1,000 player reviews and a Very Positive rating.

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01 Games & Design Case Studies



GAMEPLAY & MECHANICS

Watermelon Game

Casual physics puzzle game: drop fruits and merge matching ones to beat your high score. Built alone, released on Steam (Nov 2023) and the Microsoft Store.

- Three skills that change up the gameplay
- Multiplayer with its own stone fruit mechanic
- Golden fruit and combo counter

Steam · Very Positive (91%)
1,000+ reviews · Multiplayer
Unity · C#

Case study & design decisions →



SYSTEMS & BALANCING

Rogue Deck

In development: a multiplayer card game, simple like UNO but with deck building depth and roguelike elements. Current build is downloadable.

- Every card has a unique effect
- A second deck drives roguelike progression
- Balancing from logged playtests in a shared spreadsheet

Balancing · Economy · Roguelike
Unity · C#

Case study, LiveOps & A/B plan →



CORE LOOP & CONTROLS

Queue-Connect

Mobile arcade game: repair robots on a speeding conveyor belt. Global Game Jam 2020 entry, polished with a fellow student and published on Google Play.

- Redesigned a PC jam prototype for two-thumb play
- Rising belt speed, decoys, risk/reward buffs
- Short "one more try" score runs

Core loop · Mobile · Team project
Unity · C#

Case study →

02 Experience & Education

2023 – today
Independent Game Developer
Self-employed projects
Released Watermelon Game on Steam (Very Positive, 1,000+ reviews). Working on Rogue Deck and open-source Unity plugins.

2021 – 2023
Software Developer
5Minds IT-Solutions GmbH & Co. KG
Management software for solar plants and parks in .NET / C#, in a team of about 50 developers.

2019 – 2021
Game Programmer (Education)
School of Games, Cologne
Two-year game programming and design education with regular team game jams. Graduated 2021.

03 Skills

Game Design
Gameplay mechanics · Core loop design · Systems design · Game balancing

Design Workflow
Rapid prototyping · Gameplay telemetry · Player feedback analysis · Playtesting & iteration

Development
Unity · C# · .NET · Mobile · WebGL · Multiplayer

Tools
JetBrains Rider · Git / GitHub · Steamworks · Google Sheets

Shipping
Steam · Play Store · Microsoft Store · itch.io

04 Unity Tools & Plugins

CustomScriptTemplates

Unity editor plugin for creating and managing custom script templates.

GitHub →

Utilities

A collection of extension and utility methods for Unity projects.

GitHub →

More on GitHub

Further plugins, experiments and game projects.

All repositories →

Open to Gameplay, Systems, Technical Designer and programming roles.